

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 14, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m89-5ez9-86vy
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1411

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

We are a small team of journalists and creators that publish written news content, research topics and share insights from that research, and create unique educational podcasts and videos in the personal finance industry. Our American team creates dozens articles, videos, and podcasts every month.

We are already seeing positive and negative uses of artificial intelligence (AI). AI has made us more productive as journalists. But AI has also stolen our content, mis-attributed or created fake quotes attributed to our authors, and we have little to no recourse to resolve these issues.

As a small, US-based independent web publisher, AI is a useful tool to help analyze documents, summarize content, improve grammar, and more.

However, it also has the potential to censor content, steal content by violating copyright laws, and cut off the connection that Americans have with creators, authors, researchers, journalists, and more. It's well known that AI "hallucinates", and we see that everyday.

In the personal finance space specifically (which we focus in), incorrect AI driven answers can lead to Americans making incorrect, or even harmful, personal finance decisions.

We did a study of 100 personal finance related queries on Google, and found that their Google AI Overview was incorrect or misleading in 43% of searches (<https://thecollegeinvestor.com/47758/google-ai-misleads-in-43-of-finance-related-searches/>). This has the real potential to impact Americans negatively.

An Artificial Intelligence Action Plan should focus on harnessing the power of AI, while also protecting the basic freedoms of Americans to have access to information that is accurate, uncensored, not manipulated or misattributed, or in the worse case, not stolen by large companies and their associated "AI" models and republished as their own.

I encourage the National Science Foundation to build a framework for AI that:

1. Respects copyright law. Content that is used for AI models needs to be properly sourced and attributed. In the open web, this also means linking to the primary sources. Copyright protections exist to ensure that content creators can be compensated, and a result, will continue to create. If you weaken or remove this protection, it could create a society where there is no journalism, research, or entertainment, since AI tools would steal and misappropriate.
2. Allows content creators (publishers, journalists, independent video creators, podcast creators, etc.) to opt in or out of allowing their content used in AI models. There should be incredibly strong recourse for violations. There are already laws on copyright infringement, and this should be expanded to include AI learning.
3. In ensuring that copyright laws are protected, any framework should also ensure that content is not censored. The United States stands strong in protecting free speech, embedded in the First Amendment. Big tech companies have allegedly already engaged in using machine learning and AI to censor content, and this should not be allowed.

4. There must be a focus on factual accuracy. As we highlighted, AI answers are notoriously incorrect. There must be recourse for AI companies if they choose to allow or engage in their systems creating misinformation. If they choose to publish incorrect answers, they should be held accountable - just like any other publisher of information. This includes the ability to hold them accountable for libel and defamation, as well as errors and omissions in financial services.

We are facing an important moment in the use of new technologies that can enable a new level of productivity, economic prosperity, and more. But this same tool is a double-edged sword, and failure to regulate its use could cut deep into the American economy - creating a world where American businesses close, creators won't create because their content is stolen, news and journalism fails because the content is stolen, or a two-tiered licensed system (where some companies license content to AI and others don't) that harms competition and creates more monopolies.

Thank you for your consideration.